

Research Hotspot and Evolution Trend of REITs Since the New Century—from the Perspective of Bibliometrics

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Abstract: To understand the research status of REITs since the new century, this paper uses VOSviewer and CiteSpace software to conduct quantitative research and visual analysis on 515 relevant documents in the WOS core database from 2000 to 2022. It has found that: 1) the core author group of the research topic has been formed, the cluster structure of the cooperation network among the core authors is obvious, and the distribution of the cooperation groups is relatively clear; 2) Core journals and related journals in the research field have already been formed; 3) The research on this topic has close international cooperation. Generally speaking, as the country that first gave birth to REITs, the United States has the highest scientific productivity in this field; 4) The research presents an overview of this field through the co-occurrence analysis and evolution analysis of keywords. Combined with the analysis of mutant words, it can be considered that this research field has formed a relatively stable research trend. Through the combination of econometric analysis and visualization, the research grasps the development context of this field and provides a comprehensive and clear research framework and structure for REITs research topics.

Keywords: Knowledge map, Visual analysis, Bibliometrics, REITs.

1. Introduction

Real estate investment trusts (REITs) are trust or corporate funds that collect investors' funds and are managed by professional institutions to invest in rental real estate assets that can generate stable cash flow, and distribute the generated cash income in a timely manner in the form of dividend distribution to provide investors with long-term and stable cash income. One of the most significant advantages of REITs is to avoid double taxation. Tax drive is the driving force for the emergence, development, and innovation of the world's largest REITs market, that is, the United States REITs.

On June 21, 2020, marked by the official landing of 9 infrastructure REITs products on China's Shanghai and Shenzhen Stock Exchange, the innovative development stage of China's REITs in line with international standards has commenced, declaring the official departure of China's public offering REITs. In this context, it is necessary to sort out and analyze the research on REITs from a global perspective, so as to provide reasonable suggestions for the management of domestic REITs and the implementation of relevant policies.

2. Research Method and Materials

2.1 Research Methods

Bibliometrics is a science that takes literature as the object and adopts the ideas and methods of Metrology. Since the British scholar Pritchard proposed "Bibliometrics" in 1969, bibliometrics, as an independent discipline, has emerged in scientific quantitative researches. Especially in recent years, thanks to the rapid development of computer technology and the combination of visualization technology and metrology principles, bibliometrics analysis has become more

three-dimensional and detailed, forming a new trend of thought on quantitative analysis.

This study mainly uses econometric methods to analyze the scientific productivity of countries and authors in the research field of REITs and the publication volume of journals, describing the laws and quasi laws of scientific activities with the help of Price's law and Bradford's law of scattering, and learns the tendencies and paths of research's development through keyword cluster analysis and evolution analysis.

2.2 Research Materials

To ensure the coverage and authority of the analyzed data, this study selects the Web of Science (Core Collection) as the data source, and carries out the preliminary retrieval of the data according to the following standards:

Table 1: Summary of data source and selection

Category	Specific Standard Requirements
Research database	Web of Science core collection
Citation indexes	SSCI
Searching period	January 2000 to March 22 nd 2022
Language	"English"
Searching keywords	TS=("REITs" or "REOCs" or "Real Estate Investment Trust")
Subject categories	"Economics" or "Management" or "Sociology"
Document types	"Articles" or "Review Articles"
Data extraction	Export with full records and cited references in plain text format
Sample size	669

Because the data obtained directly through retrieval may have some problems, such as repetition or inconsistency with the subject, the data needs to be preprocessed before analysis, so as to avoid affecting the analysis results due to the quality of the data itself. According to the literature screening criteria